

DEEPAK G. PAWAR



Clear Air Turbulence

BANGALORE A massive Louis Vuitton suitcase is the focal point of the terminal among the junk food and flower stores at the new Bengaluru International Airport (BIA) seemingly in an attempt to tell you how much better off you are here than at the earlier small HAL airport that was overstuffed with traffic. The massive steel and glass departure and arrival areas promise that no matter how crowded peak hours are, there's always room for everyone. BIA is probably the first step for

Bangalore in living up to being the most fashionable corporate address in India.

It wasn't easy, cutting through legal tangles even as a court was ordering scopes for renegotiations to keep the old airport open. A clause, later added to the BIA contract, stipulated that no airport within a 150 km radius of the BIA would be kept functional, which implied that the HAL airport would be closed down. A group of concerned citizens called City Connect—significant among them

TEETHING TROUBLES: The new Bangalore airport

Biocon chief Kiran Mazumdar Shaw—disagrees with the closing down of existing infrastructure, citing citizen welfare.

While the HAL airport is in the heart of the city, its Devanhalli counterpart is an hour's drive from the city limits. Authorities have provided transport for passengers, but just one operational runway and the poor road connectivity to the terminal ensure that the Bangalore travellers' woes may decrease only marginally.

And when the first flight, IC 609 from Mumbai, landed on the night of May 23, BIA CEO Albert Brunner professed himself to be "the happiest man in India". However, his enthusiasm is not being shared by too many passengers yet; the new airport is showing teething troubles such as the ATC malfunctioning and delayed flights. But as the BIA settles into rhythm, Bangalore charts out its flight path for a turbulence-free ride.

by Swagata Sen

SIGNPOSTS

DIED: Producer **Jhamu Sughand**, who made movies like *Satya*, *Lagaan*, *Hum Dil Dey Chuke Sanam*. He was 57.



ELECTED: **Agatha Kongkal** as the first woman member of the Lok Sabha from

Meghalaya. She won from the Tura constituency. She is the daughter of former Lok Sabha speaker P.A. Sangma.

DIED: **Erman R. Bastian**, 74, former hockey player. He played for India in the 1960 Rome Olympics and in the 1962 Jakarta Asian Games.

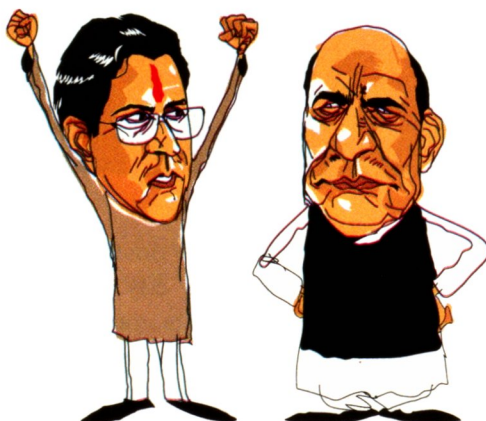
WON: By **Chetan Anand**, the Spanish Open Badminton Championship in Madrid, Spain. He beat Henri Hurskainen of Sweden.

DIED: **Dr Om Prakash Ghai**, former dean and head of the department of paediatrics for over 25 years at AIIMS in Delhi.

VIS-A-VIS **RAJ THACKERAY** Maharashtra Navnirman Sena chief **versus** **RAJNATH SINGH** BJP president

“
Students from Uttar Pradesh and Bihar are arrogant and eve-teasers.

If they persist, they will be beaten up.
”



SAURABH SINGH

“
People who indulge in politics of casteism and regionalism should have no place in the country's polity.

EPILOGUE: Will those caught eve-teasing be spared the rod if they turn out to be Marathas, Mr Thackeray?